

D583

Foundations in Public Health

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A county health department with 85 employees and a newly redesigned website analyzes hospital discharge data to track rising childhood asthma rates by zip code. Which core function is it performing?

- A. Policy development.
- B. None, because tracking data is research, not public health practice.
- C. Assessment.
- D. Assurance, because the department is assuring data quality.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is an example of the assurance function?

- A. Tracking weekly flu case reports.
- B. Running vaccine clinics in an area where no private providers offer them.
- C. Drafting a smoke-free workplace ordinance.
- D. Guaranteeing that no resident ever gets sick.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

During a Salmonella outbreak linked to a food festival that draws 20,000 visitors, health department epidemiologists interview sick people and test food samples to find the source. Which essential public health service is this?

- A. Mobilize partnerships with the festival organizers.
- B. Build and support a skilled public health workforce.
- C. Improve and innovate through evaluation and research.
- D. Investigate, diagnose, and address health problems and hazards.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A doctor at a busy urban clinic that recently added evening hours diagnoses lead poisoning in a two-year-old who lives in an older rental building. What is the distinctly public health response?

- A. Wait for more cases before acting.
- B. Inspect the building for lead hazards and test other children who may be exposed.
- C. Make sure this child receives the best available treatment.
- D. Extend clinic hours so more families can come in.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A state health office with a \$2 million prevention budget and a newly appointed commissioner wants the greatest population impact on heart disease. According to the health impact pyramid, which option ranks highest?

- A. Prescribing cholesterol drugs to high-risk patients.
- B. Running a heart-health education campaign.
- C. Removing artificial trans fats from all restaurant food statewide.
- D. Funding one-on-one counseling by physicians.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which tier of the health impact pyramid needs the most individual effort and reaches the fewest people?

- A. Socioeconomic factors.
- B. Clinical interventions.
- C. Counseling and education.
- D. Changing the context to make healthy choices the default.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A city, which hosts a marathon each spring, passes a zoning rule requiring sidewalks in all new housing developments to encourage walking. At which social-ecological level does this intervention act?

- A. Public policy.
- B. Community.
- C. Organizational.
- D. Individual.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company changes its cafeteria menu and offers standing desks to its employees. At which social-ecological level is this?

- A. Public policy.
- B. Organizational.
- C. Individual.
- D. Interpersonal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A lecturer, who spent a decade at a state health department, notes that U.S. life expectancy rose by about 30 years during the 20th century. What explains most of that gain?

- A. Advances in hospital surgery.
- B. Medical care alone.
- C. Genetic changes in the population.
- D. Public health measures such as clean water, sanitation, vaccination, and safer food.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A health department that hired a design agency with an award-winning portfolio is planning a flu-vaccine campaign for young adults. Surveys show the main barrier is that clinic hours conflict with work. Which change addresses Place in the four Ps?

- A.** Make the vaccine free.
- B.** Hire more designers from the agency.
- C.** Write catchier slogans.
- D.** Offer shots at workplaces and at pharmacies with evening hours.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A person with measles refuses to stay home in a state where the governor recently signed a new budget bill. Which level of government holds the primary legal authority to order this person's isolation?

- A.** The state, often acting through its local health officers.
- B.** The World Health Organization.
- C.** Only the federal government may restrict a person's movement.
- D.** The CDC.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is a primary role of the CDC in the U.S. public health system?

- A.** Funding and advising state and local health departments and running national surveillance.
- B.** Holding general police power over state residents.
- C.** Carrying out most routine restaurant inspections.
- D.** Licensing physicians.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A county health department ~~with 85 employees and a newly redesigned website~~ analyzes hospital discharge data to track rising childhood asthma rates by zip code. Which core function is it performing?

Target word: core function **Decides:** Collecting and analyzing population health data.

A	Adjacent category	Policy development uses the data to set plans; no plan is being made yet.
B	Absolute language	Surveillance is a routine public health function.
C	Correct	Monitoring and analyzing community health data is assessment.
D	Confusion set	Assurance is about making sure services exist, not checking data.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which activity is an example of the assurance function?

Target word: identify assurance **Decides:** Making sure needed services are delivered.

A	Confusion set	That is surveillance, part of assessment.
B	Correct	Assurance fills gaps so people can get needed services.
C	Adjacent category	Writing laws and plans is policy development.
D	Absolute language	Assurance ensures access to services, not zero disease.

3. Answer D Concept 2

During a Salmonella outbreak linked to a food festival ~~that draws 20,000 visitors~~, health department epidemiologists interview sick people and test food samples to find the source. Which essential public health service is this?

Target word: essential service **Decides:** Finding the cause of an outbreak.

A	Camouflage	Reacts to the festival; the activity described is investigation.
B	Adjacent category	Workforce development is an assurance service unrelated to this activity.
C	Confusion set	Evaluation looks at program performance, not outbreak sources.
D	Correct	Outbreak investigation is the core of this service.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A doctor at a ~~busy urban clinic that recently added evening hours~~ diagnoses lead poisoning in a two-year-old who lives in an older rental building. What is the distinctly public health response?

Target word: population-level response **Decides:** One case signals a shared environmental hazard.

A	Dropped element	Ignores that one case already points to a hazard.
B	Correct	Public health finds the source and protects the whole at-risk group.
C	Adjacent category	Individual care is medicine's role; it misses others at risk.
D	Camouflage	Hours do not remove the lead source.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A state health office ~~with a \$2 million prevention budget and a newly appointed commissioner~~ wants the greatest population impact on heart disease. According to the health impact pyramid, which option ranks highest?

Target word: highest-impact tier among options **Decides:** Changing the default environment reaches everyone with little individual effort.

A	Confusion set	A clinical intervention, one tier below context change.
B	Adjacent category	Education depends on individual action and ranks low.
C	Correct	Changes the context so the healthy choice is the default for everyone.
D	Inverted operation	Counseling sits at the top of the pyramid, with the smallest population impact.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Which tier of the health impact pyramid needs the most individual effort and reaches the fewest people?

Target word: lowest-reach tier **Decides:** Top of the pyramid.

A	Inverted operation	That is the base, with the greatest reach.
B	Confusion set	Middle-upper tier; reaches more than counseling.
C	Correct	Depends on each person acting on advice; smallest reach.
D	Adjacent category	Second from the base; high reach.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A city, ~~which hosts a marathon each spring,~~ passes a zoning rule requiring sidewalks in all new housing developments to encourage walking. At which social-ecological level does this intervention act?

Target word: level of intervention **Decides:** A government rule.

A	Correct	Laws and regulations from government act at the policy level.
B	Adjacent category	Community-level efforts involve local groups and norms, not enacted rules.
C	Confusion set	Organizational changes are made by a workplace, school, or agency for its members.
D	Inverted operation	Walking is individual, but the change is made at the policy level.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A company changes its cafeteria menu and offers standing desks to its employees. At which social-ecological level is this?

Target word: level of intervention **Decides:** An employer changing its own setting.

A	Adjacent category	Policy level is government law, not a company decision.
B	Correct	An institution changing its environment or rules for members.
C	Dropped element	Ignores who made the change.
D	Confusion set	Interpersonal is family, friends, and peers.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A lecturer, ~~who spent a decade at a state health department,~~ notes that U.S. life expectancy rose by about 30 years during the 20th century. What explains most of that gain?

Target word: main driver of the gain **Decides:** Population-level measures.

A	Adjacent category	Medical care helped, but accounts for a smaller share.
B	Absolute language	Ignores the larger role of population measures.
C	Confusion set	Genes do not change meaningfully in a century.
D	Correct	Most of the gain is credited to these population-level measures.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A health department ~~that hired a design agency with an award-winning portfolio~~ is planning a flu-vaccine campaign for young adults. Surveys show the main barrier is that clinic hours conflict with work. Which change addresses Place in the four Ps?

Target word: Place fix **Decides:** Barrier is where and when the vaccine is available.

A	Adjacent category	Targets Price, not the scheduling barrier.
B	Camouflage	Reacts to the agency detail; does not address access.
C	Confusion set	Targets Promotion; the barrier is access.
D	Correct	Place is about access: location and timing.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A person with measles refuses to stay home in a state ~~where the governor recently signed a new budget bill.~~ Which level of government holds the primary legal authority to order this person's isolation?

Target word: who holds authority **Decides:** Police power over residents rests with states.

A	Correct	States hold police power for public health and often delegate it locally.
B	Confusion set	WHO sets guidance; it has no power over individuals.
C	Absolute language	States routinely use isolation and quarantine powers.
D	Adjacent category	Federal quarantine authority centers on interstate and international spread.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

Which is a primary role of the CDC in the U.S. public health system?

Target word: federal role **Decides:** Funding, guidance, national surveillance, and interstate control.

A	Correct	The federal role is support, guidance, and national coordination.
B	Confusion set	Police power lies with the states.
C	Adjacent category	Local health departments usually do this.
D	Inverted operation	States license health professionals.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	12	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The three core functions	Assessment gathers and analyzes community health data; policy development turns evidence into plans and laws; assurance makes sure needed services and a capable workforce exist.	Calling any data-driven activity policy, or treating assurance as guaranteeing zero disease.	Is the agency measuring, deciding, or delivering?
2	The 10 essential public health services	The ten services sort under the three core functions, with equity at the center; investigating outbreaks and hazards is an assessment service.	Matching an activity to a service by who is involved rather than what is being done.	A specific department activity to classify.
3	Population vs. individual focus	Medicine treats the individual patient; public health looks for the shared cause and acts to protect the whole population.	Answering with the best treatment for the one person.	One case that points to a community-wide hazard.
4	The health impact pyramid	Interventions that change socioeconomic conditions or the default environment reach the most people with least individual effort; counseling and education reach the fewest.	Ranking education or one-on-one counseling as highest impact.	"Greatest population impact" among options.
5	Social-ecological model	Health is shaped at individual, interpersonal, organizational, community, and public-policy levels; interventions are classified by the level they change.	Classifying by the behavior targeted rather than the level acted on.	Who made the change: a person, a family, an employer, a community, or government.
6	What drove historic gains	Most of the roughly 30-year rise in U.S. life expectancy in the 20th century is credited to public health measures such as clean water, sanitation, vaccination, and safer food.	Crediting hospital medicine alone.	Long-run life-expectancy trends.
7	Social marketing's four Ps	Product (the behavior and its benefits), Price (costs and barriers), Place (where and when it is available), Promotion (messages and channels).	Fixing promotion when the barrier is place or price.	A stated barrier to mapping onto a P.
8	Who holds public health authority	States hold primary police power for public health and often delegate it to local health departments; federal agencies fund, guide, and control interstate and international spread.	Assuming the CDC or WHO directly orders local isolation or inspections.	"Which level of government has the authority?"

Course scope (public description): Foundations in Public Health introduces learners to the nation's public health systems including an overview of the core functions of Public Health and the 10 essential public health services. Learners examine a variety of strategies to promote health, prevent disease, and prolong life among populations and communities, including behavioral, population, and policy change, mass media approaches, and community-based interventions. This course also provides learners with a foundational and historical orientation to the field of public health by examining the philosophy, history, purpose, organization, terminology, and function.